Rank the season a team earned

Results-only résumé research · 2026-10-13 · America/Denver

Résumé = actual wins minus the wins a top-25 benchmark expects against the same schedule. A difficult win earns more; a bad loss costs more. Road results account for venue. Later opponent results revalue earlier games.

Opponent quality is regularized Bradley–Terry from current-season wins, losses and venues. Remove all focal-team games before fitting its opponents and the reference. All teams start equal. Ridge 0.5 and home advantage 0.3 log odds were calibrated on dated 2014–2019 future-game probabilities. Benchmark rank 25 and additive scoring are declared policies. There are no team/division priors, margins, polls, EPA, betting prices, or preseason rankings in the résumé.

Historical comparison: 2021–2025 final FBS standings

Method	Result agreement	Games
Record difficulty (Poisson-binomial)	80.91%	3864
Results-only Bradley-Terry	80.80%	3864
Colley	80.77%	3864
Wins above top-25 benchmark	80.64%	3864
Previous frozen-credit v2	79.76%	3864
Net wins	78.56%	3864
Win percentage	78.47%	3864

Agreement places a completed game’s winner above its loser, with ties worth half. It is descriptive consistency, not future prediction, objective résumé ground truth, or proof of superiority. Colley and Bradley–Terry remain competitive. The full HTML report covers seven methods, Week 6/final snapshots, FBS/all modeled games, and 24 seasons from 2002–2025.

The separate results-only strength component predicted winners on 13,594 dated FBS games at 69.24% accuracy. This does not measure résumé ordering. Neural prediction models remain separate.

2026 · through completed Week 6

Cutoff: 2026-10-11 08:30 UTC. Combined FBS/FCS field; original full-field ranks.

Rank	Team	Record	Above benchmark	Previous rank
1	Notre Dame	6-0	2.042	3
2	Georgia	6-0	1.923	2
3	Miami	5-0	1.911	8
4	Indiana	6-0	1.902	4
5	Texas Tech	5-0	1.820	12
6	Alabama	5-1	1.756	5
7	UCLA	5-0	1.715	1
8	BYU	5-0	1.483	9
9	James Madison	6-0	1.472	10
10	Kentucky	5-1	1.456	6
11	Boise State	5-1	1.387	16
12	Harvard	4-0	1.265	47
13	Texas	4-1	1.220	17
14	Tarleton State	6-0	1.149	27
15	Houston	5-1	1.145	15
16	Wake Forest	5-1	1.115	11
17	Lehigh	6-0	1.097	42
18	Mississippi State	4-1	1.055	13
19	Utah	5-0	1.033	18
20	Arizona	5-1	1.001	26
21	Ohio State	5-1	0.964	21
22	USC	6-1	0.942	7
23	Missouri	5-1	0.911	14
24	Stephen F. Austin	6-0	0.896	45
25	Nebraska	5-1	0.881	25

The interactive report includes all 266 teams and every per-game receipt. The original frozen-credit standing is retained as earnedHeight/earnedRank. Legacy projections explicitly target frozen earned points; they are not forecasts of this résumé rank.

Integrity and limits

Flipping a loss to a win on the same schedule increases a team’s résumé by exactly one, without changing its benchmark probabilities. Margin-only changes leave every résumé unchanged. Road wins receive more credit than equivalent home wins. Receipts sum to each score. Independent Python and TypeScript implementations reproduce the current standings.

Early schedules are sparse and sometimes disconnected. Equal priors avoid imposing a division hierarchy, but cannot supply missing evidence. Opponents with fewer than three independent modeled results trigger a limited-evidence flag. Supporting opponents outside the modeled field receive zero quality credit for wins and a full loss cost.

Record probability is a Poisson-binomial diagnostic: the chance a benchmark matches or exceeds the observed win total. Conditional game independence is assumed; rating uncertainty is not integrated. It is not the selected score or a confidence level.

All historical seasons have been inspected. The comparisons are retrospective development, not pristine holdouts. The archived v2 calibration postdates 2002–2013. Score availability is approximated as six hours after kickoff; historical publication vintages are not certified. No objective ground-truth résumé ranking exists, and no universal or market-beating claim follows from these comparisons.

Reproduction

```
OPENBLAS_NUM_THREADS=1 python research/resume/study.py calibrate

OPENBLAS_NUM_THREADS=1 python research/resume/study.py evaluate

OPENBLAS_NUM_THREADS=1 python research/resume/compare_legacy.py

npm run compute

npm run audit-resume -- 2026

OPENBLAS_NUM_THREADS=1 python research/resume/report.py

npm run typecheck; npm test; npm run verify; npm run build
```